

111 Subordinating conjunctions

Subordinating conjunctions are used to connect words, phrases, and clauses of unequal importance. They're used to say why, where, or when something happens.

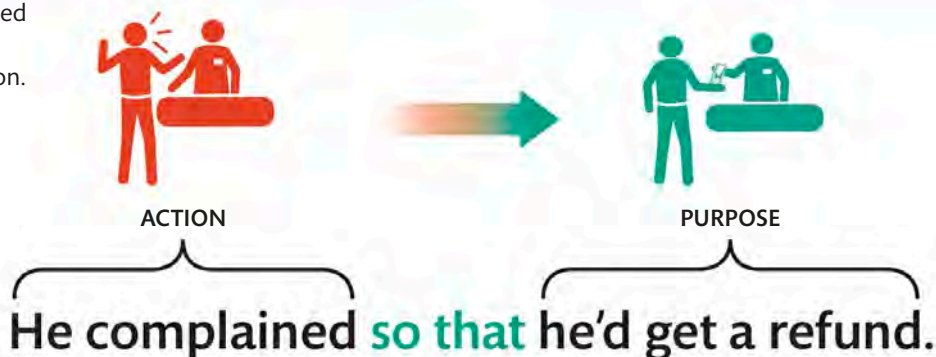
See also:

Present simple **1** Modal verbs **56**

Defining relative clauses **81**

111.1 SUBORDINATING CONJUNCTIONS FOR PURPOSE

"So that" can be used to talk about the purpose of an action. It is followed by another clause.



"So that" is often followed by modal verbs such as "can," "could," and "would."

"In order to" has a similar meaning to "so that," but it's followed by a verb in its base form.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

She went back to the store **in order to** show them her receipt.



The assistant took the receipt **to** process the refund.



In informal speech, "in order" is often dropped.

If the main verb is in the past tense, the verb after "so that" usually refers to the past.

She reported the problem **so that** it could be fixed.



If the main verb is in the present tense, the verb after "so that" usually refers to the present or future.

They check everything **so that** customers don't receive broken items.

